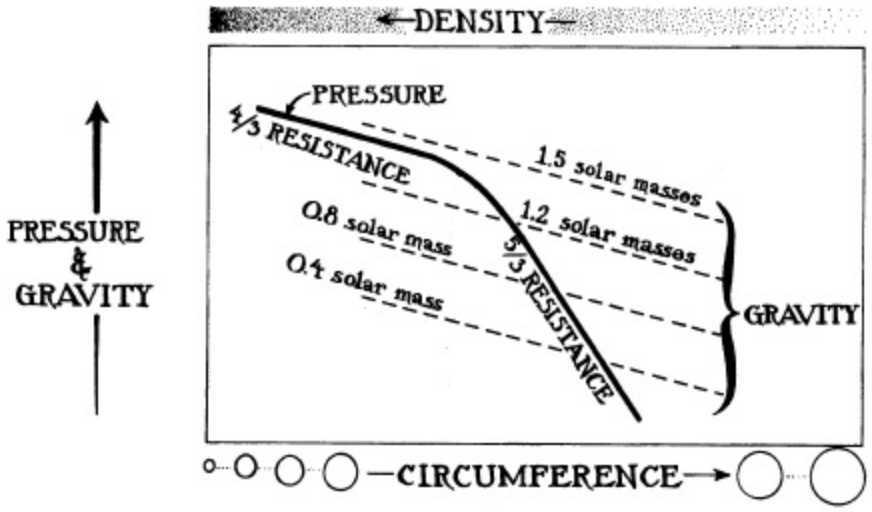


Suppressing his annoyance, Chandrasekhar went down to dinner. Eddington was there, dining at high table, but protocol dictated that, just because' you knew so eminent a man, and just because he had been expressing an interest in your work, you did not thereby have a right to go bother him about such a matter as this. So Chandrasekhar sat down elsewhere and held his tongue.

After dinner Eddington himself sought Chandrasekhar out and said, "I've asked Smart to give you half an hour tomorrow instead of the customary fifteen minutes." Chandrasekhar thanked him and waited for him to say something about his own talk, but Eddington just excused himself and left. Chandrasekhar's annoyance acquired an anxious twinge.

The Battle

The next morning Chandrasekhar took the train down to London and a taxi to Burlington House, the home of the Royal Astronomical Society. While he and a friend, Bill McCrea, were waiting for the meeting to start, Eddington came walking by, and McCrea, having just read the program, asked, "Well, Professor Eddington, what are we to understand by 'Relativistic Degeneracy'?" Eddington, in reply, turned to Chandrasekhar and said, "That's a surprise for you," and walked off leaving Chandrasekhar even more anxious.